

Paulo G. Laurence, Ph.D.

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Education

Mackenzie Presbyterian University <i>Ph.D. in Developmental Disabilities</i>	São Paulo, Brazil 2018–2021
Mackenzie Presbyterian University <i>M.S. in Developmental Disabilities</i>	São Paulo, Brazil 2016–2018
Mackenzie Presbyterian University <i>B.S. in Biological Sciences</i>	São Paulo, Brazil 2012–2016
UNINTER International University Center <i>B.Ed. in Pedagogy</i>	Brazil 2025–2026
Mackenzie Presbyterian University <i>B.Ed. with Biology specialization</i>	São Paulo, Brazil 2012–2015

Academic Profile

- **Research interests:** Development of cognitive abilities, particularly executive function and reasoning; cultural, social, and environmental influences on cognition; individual variability and cognitive strategies in problem solving.
- **Current position:** Collaborating Researcher, Center of Mathematics, Computing and Cognition (CMCC), Federal University of ABC (UFABC), Brazil.
- **Research methods:** Experimental cognitive and developmental research, eye-tracking, quantitative methods, and analysis of individual differences and cognitive strategies.

Academic Appointments & Research Experience

Federal University of ABC (UFABC) <i>Collaborating Researcher, Center of Mathematics, Computing and Cognition</i>	São Bernardo do Campo, Brazil 2026–Present
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- Leads a FAPESP-funded research program examining cultural influences on executive function and its connections with relational reasoning.
- Conducts research on cognitive development, culturally relevant assessment, executive function, reasoning, and real-world cognition.

Federal University of ABC (UFABC) <i>Visiting Professor, Center of Mathematics, Computing and Cognition</i>	São Bernardo do Campo, Brazil 2025–2026
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- Conducted research and taught courses in cognitive, developmental, and experimental psychology within an interdisciplinary cognitive science environment.

University of California, Davis <i>Visiting Postdoctoral Researcher, Center for Mind and Brain</i>	Davis, CA, USA 2024
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- Conducted developmental psychology research under the supervision of Yuko Munakata through a FAPESP Research Internship Abroad fellowship.

Mackenzie Presbyterian University <i>Postdoctoral Researcher, Human Developmental Sciences Graduate Program</i>	São Paulo, Brazil 2022–2025
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- Conducted research on executive function, reasoning, eye movements, and individual differences under the supervision of Elizeu C. Macedo.

University of California, Berkeley <i>Visiting Scholar, Building Blocks of Cognition Laboratory</i>	Berkeley, CA, USA 2020–2021
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- Conducted research on reasoning and cognitive strategies under the supervision of Silvia A. Bunge (remote due to the COVID-19 pandemic).

- Taught courses in Sensory Processes and Learning.

Selected Funding & Honors

São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP)

New Generation of Researchers Program

Brazil

2026–Present

- Principal investigator of *Foundations of the Building Blocks of Higher Cognition: Cultural Influences on Executive Functions and Their Connections with Relational Reasoning*. Approximate total direct funding: US\$446,000.

São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP)

Postdoctoral Fellowship

Brazil

2022–2025

São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP)

Research Internship Abroad Fellowship, University of California, Davis

Brazil

2024

São Paulo Research Foundation (FAPESP)

Research Internship Abroad Fellowship, University of California, Berkeley

Brazil

2020

Mackenzie Presbyterian University

Best Developmental Disabilities Program Dissertation of 2021

Brazil

2022

Mackenzie Presbyterian University

Distinction and Praise in M.S.; graduated with Honors

Brazil

2018

Selected Publications

[View full publication list on Google Scholar](#)

- **Laurence, P. G.**, Rodrigues, M. d. M., Jana, T. A., & Macedo, E. C. (2026). What lab-based and self-report executive function measures predict in real-world task performance. *Neuropsychology*. Advance online publication. doi:10.1037/neu0001117
- **Laurence, P. G.** (2026). Executive Function Beyond Minority World Contexts: A Call for Culturally Relevant Assessments in Historically Overlooked Populations in Majority World Countries. *Mind, Brain, and Education*, 20(1), e70034. doi:10.1111/mbe.70034
- **Laurence, P. G.** (2025). Breaking the mould of executive function research. *Nature Reviews Psychology*, 4, 309. doi:10.1038/s44159-025-00437-x
- **Laurence, P. G.**, Jana, T. A., Bunge, S. A., & Macedo, E. C. (2023). Eye Gaze Patterns during Reasoning Provide Insights Regarding Individual Differences in Underlying Cognitive Abilities. *Journal of Intelligence*, 11(4), 75. doi:10.3390/jintelligence11040075
- **Laurence, P. G.**, & Macedo, E. C. (2023). Cognitive strategies in matrix-reasoning tasks: State of the art. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, 30, 147–159. doi:10.3758/s13423-022-02160-7

Academic Service & Professional Memberships

- **Associate Editor:** *Psychology: Research and Review (Psicologia: Reflexão e Crítica)*, 2024–Present.
- **Peer reviewer:** *Frontiers in Developmental Psychology; Frontiers in Psychology; International Journal of Developmental Disabilities; Cogent Education; Journal of Cognition and Development; Social Neuroscience; Developmental Science; Cognitive Processing; Journal of Cognitive Psychology; Journal of Intelligence; Frontiers in Psychiatry; Visual Cognition; PLOS ONE; Behavior Research Methods*.
- **Professional memberships:** Society for Research in Child Development; Cognitive Development Society.